

Parts of speech

WORDS ARE THE BUILDING BLOCKS OF LANGUAGE, BUT THEY MUST BE ARRANGED IN A RECOGNIZABLE ORDER.

Parts of speech refer to the way in which particular words are used. Some words can be classified as more than one word type, and they change type according to the sentence they belong to.

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Word types

The main parts of speech are nouns, verbs, adjectives, pronouns, adverbs, prepositions, and conjunctions. Interjections are also important, since they are used so often in everyday speech. Nouns (or pronouns) and verbs are the only essential components of a sentence.

▽ Different roles

Each type of word performs a different function. Some depend on others for sense; some exist solely to modify others.

Noun

A word used to name a person, animal, place, or thing.

EXAMPLES

William, mouse, supermarket, ladder, desk, station, ball, boy

ball



Adjective

A word used to describe a noun or pronoun.

EXAMPLES

shiny, dangerous, new, bouncy, noisy, colorful, wooden

colorful ball



Verb

A word that expresses an action or a state of being.

EXAMPLES

run, be, kick, go, think, do, play, stumble, touch

kick the ball



Adverb

A word that describes and adds information to a verb or a verb phrase.

EXAMPLES

quickly, soon, very, rather, too, almost, only, quietly

quickly kick the ball



Pronoun

A word that takes the place of a noun.

EXAMPLES

he, she, them, him, we, you, us, mine, yours, theirs

kick the ball to him



Preposition

A word that indicates the relationship between two people or things, usually in terms of where they are.

EXAMPLES

with, under, on, behind, into, over, across

kick the ball behind you

